

Mauch Gets to Park Early, Has Time to Review Past

By MILTON RICHMAN
NEW YORK (UPI)—Gene Mauch didn't want to miss anything.
The ball game was due to start at 2:05 p.m. but the Montreal manager doesn't like any of these last-minute propositions.
He had breakfast at 8 a.m. Tuesday, took the subway out to the ballpark after he was finished and was in the visiting team manager's private office at Shea Stadium, all set for the game with the New York Mets, by 9:30.
Gene Mauch hardly noticed the threat of rain in the air as he came off the subway into the ballpark. This was a special day. Opening day.
"I remember my first one," he said, smoking a cigaret and chewing gum at the same time while sitting behind the huge black desk in his office. "It was in Shibe Park, Philadelphia, and the year was 1944. I was with the Dodgers, we were playing the Phillies, and I wouldn't say I was nervous ... That wasn't the word really ... But I was excited."
Mauch put his cigaret in the metal ash tray on his desk and remembered some more about that first opener he was in. He was only 18 at the time.
"Kewpie Dick Barrett was pitching for the Phillies," Mauch said. "My first time up I grounded out to shortstop. I couldn't wait for my second time up and when it came I doubled to left center. In the 10th Paul Waner pinch hit for me and won the game."
Sixteen years later things hadn't changed much for the Phillies. It was 1960 and Eddie Sawyer was the manager but they lost the opener again. Sawyer quit right then and there.
John Quinn, the Phils' general manager, got on the phone and called Mauch in Homestead, Fla., where the Minneapolis farm team he managed was doing its spring training.
"Are you ready to manage my club?" Quinn asked him.
"I'm ready," Mauch said.
He joined the Phillies in time to manage them in their third game of the season with the Braves (coach Andy Cohen had handled them in the second game).
Mauch's major league managerial debut was a great one—for the other side. The Braves bombed the Phillies, 13-5.
"You know," said the Montreal manager, giving his chewing gum a good workout, "I'm anxious for this season to get started. I feel the same way right now as I'll feel July 25. Excited."
By now the Montreal players were beginning to stream into the clubhouse. They reported it

was raining outside.
Later it turned even worse. A bone-chilling wind accompanied the rain and only a relative handful of the 26,062 who turned out at Shea Stadium remained in their seats for long.
Mauch wasn't too concerned with the conditions. He held a 20-minute meeting with his players before the game started. Discussing new playing rules, the kind of defense to set up against each Met batter and the genuine eagerness he felt about the new season.
"I want everyone on the field

by 1:15," said the Montreal manager. "They haven't said whether we're going to play yet or not but when you go out there to do your running, run as if we're going to play. It's perfect weather for us. Okay, fellas, let's go!"
The Mets beat the Expos, 4-2, in the wind, the rain and the cold and with two out in the last of the fifth inning the umpires called time, waited an hour and then declared that was as far as the contest would go.
Gene Mauch, who came out to the ballpark early so as not to miss a thing, was not happy about the opening day loss. But neither did he let it get him down.
"We'll get it back somewhere else along the line," he said.

Local Sports Schedule

THURSDAY
(April 8)
Golf: Western Intercollegiate Tournament at Santa Cruz.

FRIDAY
(April 9)
Golf: Western Intercollegiate Tournament at Santa Cruz.

SATURDAY
(April 10)
Track: Chico State at Sacramento State College Relays, 5 p.m.

CSC Nine Falls To Stanford 5-1

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the season. Today, weather permitting, they took on San Jose State in San Jose, playing a doubleheader.
Following is yesterday's box score:

STANFORD (5)				
Edison, 2b	4	1	1	
Borchers, cf	3	1	0	
Boone, lf	3	1	1	
Lucich, 1b	4	1	2	
Rusco, 3b	2	0	0	
Marshall, rf	4	0	2	
Reese, c	3	0	1	
O'Brien, ss	3	1	1	
Schoen, p	3	0	0	
Totals	29	5	8	
CHICO (1)				
Bradley, ss	4	0	0	
Salsedo, 2b	4	0	2	
Menefee, cf	4	0	0	
Marshall, 1b	4	0	1	
McSweeney, lf	4	1	1	
Hering, 3b	4	0	0	
Sjoberg, c	2	0	1	
Tilton, c	1	0	0	
Rice, rf	2	0	0	
Loez, rf	1	0	0	
Brown, p	2	0	0	
McShane, ph	1	0	1	
Barker, p	0	0	0	
Totals	33	1	4	
Chico State	000 010 000-1			
Stanford	000 030 11x-5			
WINNER: Schoen; LOSER: Brown.				

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